# INDIAN POLITICAL GEOGRAPHY: BOUNDARIES AND NEIGHBOURS

**POLITICAL-GEOGRAPHY VOCABULARY RAIL → FOUR STAGES OF BOUNDARY → BOUNDARY CLASSIFICATION MATRIX → DISPUTE-CAUSE TYPOLOGY → FRONTIER TO BOUNDARY CONVERSION → CLASSICAL LENSES AND THEIR**

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ◦ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g2 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

## 00 STAGE 00 POLITICAL-GEOGRAPHY VOCABULARY RAIL

POLITICAL-GEOGRAPHY VOCABULARY RAIL · RECOGNISED LINE SEPARATING TERRITORY OR JURISDICTION OF TWO STATES · WIDER ZONE OF TRANSITION WHERE AUTHORITY THINS OUT · LIVED HUMAN-USE SPACE ON EITHER SIDE OF THE LINE · TERRITORY ENTIRELY ENCLOSED BY ANOTHER STATE'S TERRITORY · DETACHED PART OF A STATE SEPARATED BY ANOTHER STATE'S

**BOUNDARY — recognised line separating territory or jurisdiction of two states**

FRONTIER — wider zone of transition where authority thins out → BORDERLAND — lived human-use space on either side of the line → ENCLAVE — territory entirely enclosed by another state's territory

| DEFINITION / COMPONENTS | TRIGGER / MECHANISM | EFFECT / INTERVENTION |
|---|---|---|
| • BOUNDARY → recognised line separating territory or jurisdiction of two states<br>• FRONTIER → wider zone of transition where authority thins out | • BORDERLAND → lived human-use space on either side of the line<br>• ENCLAVE → territory entirely enclosed by another state's territory | • EXCLAVE → detached part of a state separated by another state's territory<br>• BOUNDARY → recognised line separating territory or jurisdiction of two states |

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EXCLAVE → detached part of a state separated by another state's territory.**

## 01 STAGE 01 FOUR STAGES OF BOUNDARY MAKING

FOUR STAGES OF BOUNDARY MAKING · POLITICAL DECISION ON WHO RECEIVES WHICH TERRITORY · THE LINE IS DRAWN IN MAP AND TEXT FORM · PILLARS, FENCES, COORDINATES OR A CHANNEL REFERENCE ON THE · CHECK POSTS, PATROLS, CROSSINGS AND SETTLEMENT MANAGEMENT · WEAK POINTS · A PAPER LINE NEVER MARKED, AND A DEFINING FEATURE

ALLOCATION — political decision on who receives which territory → DELIMITATION — the line is drawn in map and text form → DEMARCATION — pillars, fences, coordinates or a channel reference on the ground → ADMINISTRATION — check posts, patrols, crossings and settlement management → WEAK POINTS — a paper line never marked, and a defining feature that later moves

| DEFINITION / COMPONENTS | TRIGGER / MECHANISM | EFFECT / INTERVENTION |
|---|---|---|
| • ALLOCATION → political decision on who receives which territory<br>• DELIMITATION → the line is drawn in map and text form | • DEMARCATION → pillars, fences, coordinates or a channel reference on the ground<br>• ADMINISTRATION → check posts, patrols, crossings and settlement management | • WEAK POINTS → a paper line never marked, and a defining feature that later moves<br>• ALLOCATION → political decision on who receives which territory |

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: WEAK POINTS → a paper line never marked, and a defining feature that later moves.**

## 02 STAGE 02 BOUNDARY CLASSIFICATION MATRIX

BOUNDARY CLASSIFICATION MATRIX · PHYSICAL FORM · NATURAL FOLLOWS MOUNTAIN, RIVER, WATERSHED, DESERT OR SEA · GEOMETRIC FOLLOWS A STRAIGHT OR COORDINATE-BASED LINE · ANTECEDENT DRAWN BEFORE DENSE SETTLEMENT; SUBSEQUENT ADJUSTED TO IT · SUPERIMPOSED CUTS ACROSS EXISTING FABRIC; RELICT SURVIVES IN LANDSCAPE · GENESIS PREDICTS DISPUTE TYPE; NEITHER FORM IS INTRINSICALLY STABLE

| CLASSIFICATION | DIAGNOSTIC BASIS | PROCESS LINK | EXAM TRAP |
|---|---|---|---|
| PHYSICAL FORM — natural follows mountain, river, watershed, desert or sea | GENESIS — antecedent drawn before dense settlement; subsequent adjusted to it | RULE — genesis predicts dispute type; neither form is intrinsically stable | PHYSICAL FORM — geometric follows a straight or coordinate-based line |
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| • PHYSICAL FORM → natural follows mountain, river, watershed, desert or sea<br>• PHYSICAL FORM → geometric follows a straight or coordinate-based line | • GENESIS → antecedent drawn before dense settlement; subsequent adjusted to it<br>• GENESIS → superimposed cuts across existing fabric; relict survives in landscape | • RULE → genesis predicts dispute type; neither form is intrinsically stable<br>• PHYSICAL FORM → natural follows mountain, river, watershed, desert or sea | • PHYSICAL FORM → geometric follows a straight or coordinate-based line<br>• GENESIS → antecedent drawn before dense settlement; subsequent adjusted to it |

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → genesis predicts dispute type; neither form is intrinsically stable.**

## 03 STAGE 03 DISPUTE-CAUSE TYPOLOGY

DISPUTE-CAUSE TYPOLOGY · IF THE PARTIES AGREE ON OWNERSHIP BUT NOT ALIGNMENT · POSITIONAL DISPUTE · IF THE PARTIES CONTEST OWNERSHIP OF A NAMED AREA · TERRITORIAL DISPUTE · IF THE LINE IS AGREED BUT USE ACROSS IT · RESOURCE OR FUNCTIONAL DISPUTE · IF THE LINE PREDATES OR CUTS ACROSS SETTLEMENT

**If the parties agree on ownership but not alignment → positional dispute**

If the parties contest ownership of a named area → territorial dispute → If the line is agreed but use across it is contested → resource or functional → If the line predates or cuts across settlement → antecedent or superimposed problem

| DEFINITION / COMPONENTS | TRIGGER / MECHANISM | EFFECT / INTERVENTION |
|---|---|---|
| • If the parties agree on ownership but not alignment → positional dispute<br>• If the parties contest ownership of a named area → territorial dispute | • If the line is agreed but use across it is contested → resource or functional dispute<br>• If the line predates or cuts across settlement → antecedent or superimposed problem | • If the defining river or watershed moves → geomorphic instability recalculates the line<br>• If the parties agree on ownership but not alignment → positional dispute |

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: If the defining river or watershed moves → geomorphic instability recalculates the line.**

## 04 STAGE 04 FRONTIER TO BOUNDARY CONVERSION

FRONTIER TO BOUNDARY CONVERSION · HISTORICAL FRONTIER · BROAD TRANSITION ZONE ADMINISTERED WITH TOLERATED AMBIGUITY · STATE CONSOLIDATION · A PRECISE LINE BECOMES LEGALLY AND MILITARILY NECESSARY · AMBIGUITY MUST BE RESOLVED INTO ONE AGREED ALIGNMENT · COMPETING READINGS OF THE SAME TERRAIN SURFACE AS CLAIMS · MANY DISPUTES BEGIN AT THE MOMENT A ZONE IS

HISTORICAL FRONTIER — broad transition zone administered with tolerated ambiguity → STATE CONSOLIDATION — a precise line becomes legally and militarily necessary → CONVERSION — ambiguity must be resolved into one agreed alignment → FRICTION — competing readings of the same terrain surface as claims → LESSON — many disputes begin at the moment a zone is asked to become a

| DEFINITION / COMPONENTS | TRIGGER / MECHANISM | EFFECT / INTERVENTION |
|---|---|---|
| • HISTORICAL FRONTIER → broad transition zone administered with tolerated ambiguity<br>• STATE CONSOLIDATION → a precise line becomes legally and militarily necessary | • CONVERSION → ambiguity must be resolved into one agreed alignment<br>• FRICTION → competing readings of the same terrain surface as claims | • LESSON → many disputes begin at the moment a zone is asked to become a line<br>• HISTORICAL FRONTIER → broad transition zone administered with tolerated ambiguity |

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LESSON → many disputes begin at the moment a zone is asked to become a line.**

## 05 STAGE 05 CLASSICAL LENSES AND THEIR OMISSIONS

CLASSICAL LENSES AND THEIR OMISSIONS · INTERIOR CONTINENTAL DEPTH AND OVERLAND ACCESS AS THE VARIABLE · COASTAL TRANSITION BELTS AROUND THE EURASIAN MARGIN · SEA POWER · NAVAL ACCESS, PORTS AND SEA LINES OF COMMUNICATION · AIR AND SPACE POWER, CYBER AND SUBMARINE CABLES, INTERDEPENDENCE · NON-STATE ACTORS AND NUCLEAR DETERRENCE; GEOGRAPHY CONDITIONS, NOT DETERMINES

| DEFINITION / COMPONENTS | TRIGGER / MECHANISM | EFFECT / INTERVENTION |
|---|---|---|
| HEARTLAND — interior continental depth and overland access as the variable | SEA POWER — naval access, ports and sea lines of communication | OMISSIONS — non-state actors and nuclear deterence; geography conditions, not determines |
| RIMLAND — coastal transition belts around the Eurasian margin | OMISSIONS — air and space power, cyber and submarine cables, interdependence | HEARTLAND — interior continental depth and overland access as the variable |

| DEFINITION / COMPONENTS | TRIGGER / MECHANISM | EFFECT / INTERVENTION |
|---|---|---|
| • HEARTLAND → interior continental depth and overland access as the variable<br>• RIMLAND → coastal transition belts around the Eurasian margin | • SEA POWER → naval access, ports and sea lines of communication<br>• OMISSIONS → air and space power, cyber and submarine cables, interdependence | • OMISSIONS → non-state actors and nuclear deterence; geography conditions, not determines<br>• HEARTLAND → interior continental depth and overland access as the variable |

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: OMISSIONS → non-state actors and nuclear deterence; geography conditions, not determines.**

## 06 STAGE 06 INDIA'S DUAL STRATEGIC CHARACTER

INDIA'S DUAL STRATEGIC CHARACTER · CONTINENTAL SIDE · MOUNTAIN AND PLAINS FRONTIER REQUIRING LAND FORCE AND INFRASTRUCTURE · MARITIME SIDE · PENINSULAR POSITION ASTRIDE MAJOR SEA LANES WITH ISLAND TERRITORIES · A GENUINE RESOURCE TRADE-OFF BETWEEN THE TWO THEATRES · ANSWER MOVE · RECOGNISE DUALITY INSTEAD OF ASSIGNING INDIA TO ONE SCHOOL

| SYSTEM / DEFINITION | PROCESS / MECHANISM | SPATIAL / INDIA PATTERN | HAZARD / LIMIT / RESPONSE |
|---|---|---|---|
| CONTINENTAL SIDE — mountain and plains frontier requiring land force and infrastructure | CONSEQUENCE — a genuine resource trade-off between the two theatres | CAUTION — avoid quoting boundary lengths or disputed areas from memory | MARITIME SIDE — peninsular position astride major sea lanes with island territories |
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| SYSTEM / DEFINITION | PROCESS / MECHANISM | SPATIAL / INDIA PATTERN | HAZARD / LIMIT / RESPONSE |
|---|---|---|---|
| • CONTINENTAL SIDE → mountain and plains frontier requiring land force and infrastructure<br>• MARITIME SIDE → peninsular position astride major sea lanes with island territories | • CONSEQUENCE → a genuine resource trade-off between the two theatres<br>• ANSWER MOVE → recognise duality instead of assigning India to one school | • CAUTION → avoid quoting boundary lengths or disputed areas from memory<br>• CONTINENTAL SIDE → mountain and plains frontier requiring land force and infrastructure | • MARITIME SIDE → peninsular position astride major sea lanes with island territories<br>• CONSEQUENCE → a genuine resource trade-off between the two theatres |

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAUTION → avoid quoting boundary lengths or disputed areas from memory.**

## 07 STAGE 07 SECTOR-BY-TERRAIN MANAGEMENT FRAMEWORK

SECTOR-BY-TERRAIN MANAGEMENT FRAMEWORK · HIGH-ALTITUDE GLACIATED · INACCESSIBILITY, WATERSHED AMBIGUITY, COSTLY INFRASTRUCTURE · DENSELY POPULATED PLAINS · FENCING FEASIBLE BUT DIVIDES FIELDS; SMUGGLING DOMINATES · RIVERINE AND DELTAIC · MIGRATING CHANNELS, SHIFTING CHAR LANDS, FENCING IMPOSSIBLE · FORESTED HILL

| DEFINITION / COMPONENTS | TRIGGER / MECHANISM | EFFECT / INTERVENTION |
|---|---|---|
| HIGH-ALTITUDE GLACIATED — inaccessibility, watershed ambiguity, costly infrastructure | RIVERINE AND DELTAIC — migrating channels, shifting char lands, fencing impossible | DESERT AND MARITIME — long-distance surveillance; zone delimitation and fishing friction |
| DENSELY POPULATED PLAINS — fencing feasible but divides fields; smuggling dominates | FORESTED HILL — cross-border ethnic continuity and traditional movement regimes | HIGH-ALTITUDE GLACIATED — inaccessibility, watershed ambiguity, costly infrastructure |

| DEFINITION / COMPONENTS | TRIGGER / MECHANISM | EFFECT / INTERVENTION |
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| • HIGH-ALTITUDE GLACIATED — inaccessibility, watershed ambiguity, costly infrastructure<br>• DENSELY POPULATED PLAINS — fencing feasible but divides fields; smuggling dominates | • RIVERINE AND DELTAIC → migrating channels, shifting char lands, fencing impossible<br>• FORESTED HILL → cross-border ethnic continuity and traditional movement regimes | • DESERT AND MARITIME → long-distance surveillance; zone delimitation and fishing friction<br>• HIGH-ALTITUDE GLACIATED → inaccessibility, watershed ambiguity, costly infrastructure |

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DESERT AND MARITIME → long-distance surveillance; zone delimitation and fishing friction.**

## 08 STAGE 08 DIFFERENTIATED BORDER MANAGEMENT FORK

DIFFERENTIATED BORDER MANAGEMENT FORK · SECTOR IDENTIFIED · STATE TERRAIN, SETTLEMENT DENSITY AND LEGAL STATUS OF THE · IF TERRAIN AND SETTLEMENT DIFFER ACROSS SECTORS · UNIFORM INSTRUMENTS WILL MISFIT · IF HARDENING IGNORES LOCAL LIVELIHOODS · ALIENATION GROWS IN THE BORDERLAND · COMBINE INFRASTRUCTURE, SURVEILLANCE AND LOCAL ECONOMIC INTEGRATION

**SECTOR IDENTIFIED — state terrain, settlement density and legal status of the line**

If terrain and settlement differ across sectors — uniform instruments will misfit → If hardening ignores local livelihoods — alienation grows in the borderland → THEREFORE — combine infrastructure, surveillance and local economic integration

| DEFINITION / COMPONENTS | TRIGGER / MECHANISM | EFFECT / INTERVENTION |
|---|---|---|
| • SECTOR IDENTIFIED → state terrain, settlement density and legal status of the line<br>• If terrain and settlement differ across sectors → uniform instruments will misfit | • If hardening ignores local livelihoods → alienation grows in the borderland<br>• THEREFORE → combine infrastructure, surveillance and local economic integration | • AND → keep force doctrine outside a geography answer; retain terrain-to-management logic<br>• SECTOR IDENTIFIED → state terrain, settlement density and legal status of the line |

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: THEREFORE → combine infrastructure, surveillance and local economic integration.**

## 09 STAGE 09 INDIA NEIGHBOUR ADJACENCY GRID

INDIA NEIGHBOUR ADJACENCY GRID · LAND NEIGHBOURS · PAKISTAN, CHINA, NEPAL, BHUTAN, BANGLADESH AND MYANMAR · CLAIMED ADJACENCY · AFGHANISTAN THROUGH INDIA'S FAR NORTH-WEST MAP POSITION · MARITIME NEIGHBOURS · SRI LANKA ACROSS THE PALK STRAIT AND GULF OF · MALDIVES ACROSS THE EIGHT DEGREE CHANNEL FROM LAKSHADWEEP

| SYSTEM / DEFINITION | PROCESS / MECHANISM | SPATIAL / INDIA PATTERN | HAZARD / LIMIT / RESPONSE |
|---|---|---|---|
| LAND NEIGHBOURS — Pakistan, China, Nepal, Bhutan, Bangladesh and Myanmar | MARITIME NEIGHBOURS — Sri Lanka across the Palk Strait and Gulf of Mannar | LAND BRIDGE — Myanmar alone opens India into mainland South-East Asia | CLAIMED ADJACENCY — Afghanistan through India's far north-west map position |
| CLAIMED ADJACENCY — Afghanistan through India's far north-west map position | MARITIME NEIGHBOURS — Maldives across the Eight Degree Channel from Lakshadweep | LAND NEIGHBOURS — Pakistan, China, Nepal, Bhutan, Bangladesh and Myanmar | MARITIME NEIGHBOURS — Sri Lanka across the Palk Strait and Gulf of Mannar |

| SYSTEM / DEFINITION | PROCESS / MECHANISM | SPATIAL / INDIA PATTERN | HAZARD / LIMIT / RESPONSE |
|---|---|---|---|
| • LAND NEIGHBOURS → Pakistan, China, Nepal, Bhutan, Bangladesh and Myanmar<br>• CLAIMED ADJACENCY → Afghanistan through India's far north-west map position | • MARITIME NEIGHBOURS → Sri Lanka across the Palk Strait and Gulf of Mannar<br>• MARITIME NEIGHBOURS → Maldives across the Eight Degree Channel from Lakshadweep | • LAND BRIDGE → Myanmar alone opens India into mainland South- East Asia<br>• LAND NEIGHBOURS → Pakistan, China, Nepal, Bhutan, Bangladesh and Myanmar | • CLAIMED ADJACENCY → Afghanistan through India's far north-west map position<br>• MARITIME NEIGHBOURS → Sri Lanka across the Palk Strait and Gulf of Mannar |

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LAND BRIDGE → Myanmar alone opens India into mainland South-East Asia.**

## 10 STAGE 10 BOUNDARY-LINE CATEGORY FIREWALL

BOUNDARY-LINE CATEGORY FIREWALL · RADCLIFFE LINE 1947 · PARTITION FRAMEWORK FOR THE BOUNDARY WITH PAKISTAN · MCMAHON LINE 1914 FRAMEWORK · EASTERN-SECTOR INDIA-CHINA BOUNDARY CLAIM · DURAND LINE 1893 · AFGHANISTAN-PAKISTAN LINE, NEVER AN INDIA-PAKISTAN LINE · CEASEFIRE LINE 1949 TO LINE OF CONTROL 1972

**RADCLIFFE LINE 1947 — partition framework for the boundary with Pakistan**

McMAHON LINE 1914 FRAMEWORK — eastern-sector India-China boundary claim → DURAND LINE 1893 — Afghanistan-Pakistan line, never an India-Pakistan line → CEASEFIRE LINE 1949 TO LINE OF CONTROL 1972 — military control, not sovereignty

| DEFINITION / COMPONENTS | TRIGGER / MECHANISM | EFFECT / INTERVENTION |
|---|---|---|
| • RADCLIFFE LINE 1947 — partition framework for the boundary with Pakistan<br>• McMAHON LINE 1914 FRAMEWORK — eastern-sector India-China boundary claim | • DURAND LINE 1893 — Afghanistan-Pakistan line, never an India-Pakistan line<br>• CEASEFIRE LINE 1949 TO LINE OF CONTROL 1972 — military control, not sovereignty | • LINE OF ACTUAL CONTROL — control reality over an undemarcated mountain frontier<br>• RADCLIFFE LINE 1947 — partition framework for the boundary with Pakistan |

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LINE OF ACTUAL CONTROL → control reality over an undemarcated mountain frontier.**

## 11 STAGE 11 SECTORS, SETTLEMENT CHAIN AND MANDATES

SECTORS, SETTLEMENT CHAIN AND MANDATES · WESTERN SECTOR · LADAKH, KARAKORAM AND AKSAI CHIN SPACE WITH WATERSHED AMBIGUITY · MIDDLE AND EASTERN SECTORS · HIMACHAL AND UTTARAKHAND; SIKKIM AND ARUNACHAL · LAND BOUNDARY AGREEMENT · 1974 ACCORD, 2011 PROTOCOL, 2015 IMPLEMENTATION · SETTLEMENT EFFECT

WESTERN SECTOR — Ladakh, Karakoram and Aksai Chin space with watershed ambiguity → MIDDLE AND EASTERN SECTORS — Himachal and Uttarakhand; Sikkim and Arunachal → LAND BOUNDARY AGREEMENT — 1974 accord, 2011 Protocol, 2015 implementation → SETTLEMENT EFFECT — enclaves, adverse possessions and undemarcated stretches resolved → MANDATES — BSF, ITBP, SSB, Assam Rifles and Coast Guard mapped to terrain

| DEFINITION / COMPONENTS | TRIGGER / MECHANISM | EFFECT / INTERVENTION |
|---|---|---|
| • WESTERN SECTOR → Ladakh, Karakoram and Aksai Chin space with watershed ambiguity<br>• MIDDLE AND EASTERN SECTORS → Himachal and Uttarakhand; Sikkim and Arunachal | • LAND BOUNDARY AGREEMENT → 1974 accord, 2011 Protocol, 2015 implementation<br>• SETTLEMENT EFFECT → enclaves, adverse possessions and undemarcated stretches resolved | • MANDATES → BSF, ITBP, SSB, Assam Rifles and Coast Guard mapped to terrain<br>• WESTERN SECTOR → Ladakh, Karakoram and Aksai Chin space with watershed ambiguity |

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MANDATES → BSF, ITBP, SSB, Assam Rifles and Coast Guard mapped to terrain.**

## E EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · NEPAL AND BHUTAN ARE HIMALAYAN NEIGHBOURS, BUT THEIR BORDER · NEPAL HAS · AN OPEN-BORDER PLAINS FOOTHILL INTERFACE, WHILE BHUTAN IS A · BANGLADESH IS INDIA'S MOST INTRICATE ALLUVIAL · ENCLAVE HISTORY CASE · MYANMAR IS THE ONLY LAND NEIGHBOUR THAT PHYSICALLY OPENS · SRI LANKA IS SEPARATED BY A SHALLOW MARITIME GAP

### OPTIONAL PROCESS DEPTH

- Nepal and Bhutan are Himalayan neighbours, but their border character differs: Nepal has
- an open-border plains foothill interface, while Bhutan is a steeper mountain-buffer interface.
- Bangladesh is India's most intricate alluvial / enclave history case.
- Myanmar is the only land neighbour that physically opens India into mainland South-East Asia.

### DATA / INSTITUTION LIMIT

- Sri Lanka is separated by a shallow maritime gap, not by a land border.
- LAC = India-China control line; LoC = India-Pakistan military control line in J&K.
- NOT: Durand Line is India's boundary with Afghanistan - it is the
- Afghanistan-Pakistan line, relevant to India's claimed north-west context, not an India-Pakistan line.

### CONTEMPORARY PARALLEL

- NOT: McMahon Line and LAC are the same everywhere - the McMahon Line relates to the eastern sector's boundary claim
- the LAC is the broader present control reality.
- NOT: Border guarding forces and legal boundaries are the same subject - the former manage terrain; the latter define sovereignty.
- CAUTION: Recurring Prelims theme: identify which Indian states touch which neighbour.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels